

TOTAL MEDALS AT STAKE

18

MEN'S
SINGLES

ABHAY SINGH

Ranked 24th in the PSA Rankings, Abhay Singh is the second-best male Asian player at the moment.

It has been a breakout season for the 28-year-old from Chennai. In March, he won his maiden title on the PSA World Tour at the JSW Indian Open in Mumbai. On the Challenger Tour, he took his tally to 13 titles with the Tuanku Muhriz Trophy. His sole loss against an Asian player came in the first round of the World Championships, where he went down to compatriot Veer Chotrani in a decider.

The winner of the men's singles event in Aichi-Nagoya will be assured of a spot when the sport makes its Olympic debut in Los Angeles in 2028. Abhay's eyes will be firmly on that gold medal, but he may have to overcome the biggest obstacle in his path in the form of Malaysian World No. 19 and reigning champion Eain Yow Ng — a player who has a 4-0 head-to-head advantage over him.

VEER CHOTRANI,
ABHAY SINGH, VELAVAN
SENTHILKUMAR, SURAJ KUMAR CHAND

The Indian men's team is the reigning Asian Games champion. In Hangzhou, the side defeated Pakistan 2-1 in a thrilling final, with Abhay Singh beating Noor Zaman in the third and deciding singles rubber after saving two match balls.

That Indian team featured experienced names such as Saurav Ghosal, Mahesh Mangaonkar and Harinder Pal Sandhu. While Saurav and Mahesh have stepped away from professional squash, Harinder will travel with the side as a coach this time. World No. 24 Abhay is the leader of the group, which also includes Veer Chotrani (World No. 38), Velavan Senthilkumar (World No. 54) and Suraj Kumar Chand (World No. 98).

In terms of squad depth, India and Pakistan are the two strongest outfits, and a repeat of the 2023 final is a strong possibility, with the former likely to retain its title.

MEN'S
TEAM

R. RAVINDRAN